INCH-POUND

MIL-C-63990C (AR)
AMENDMENT 3
15 September 1996
SUPERSEDING
AMENDMENT 2
28 February 1995

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

CARTRIDGE, 5.56mm, TRACER, M856

This amendment forms a part of MIL-C-63990 (AR), dated 15 February 1994, and is approved for use by the US Army Armament, Research, Development and Engineering Center, and is available for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

PAGE 2

2.1.1 Under military specifications delete the following:

"MIL-L-3150	Lubricating Oil, Preservative, Medium
MIL-C-16173	Corrosion Preventive Compound, Solvent Cutback, Cold Application"

PAGE 8

4.4.1 Add the following:

"Jacket, Pointed	9357839	25
Jacket, Pointed with Filler, Point	9357840	25"

PAGE 9

TABLE I Delete "Sheet 1 of 4" and substitute "Sheet 1 of 6".

Delete "wall thickness variation (2 locations)" and substitute "wall thickness variation".

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PAGE 10

TABLE I Delete "Sheet 2 of 4" and substitute "Sheet 2 of 6".

Add sheet 3 of 6 included as page 3 (10a).

Add sheet 4 of 6 included as page 4 (10b).

PAGE 11

TABLE I Delete "Sheet 3 of 4" and substitute "Sheet 5 of 6".

PAGE 12

TABLE I Delete "Sheet 4 of 4" and substitute "Sheet 6 of 6".

Under Examination or Test Column, delete "Critical" and substitute "Critical/Special"

PAGE 14

4.5.6 Delete the last sentence and substitute the following:

"If a visual critical or special defect is found in a sample either just prior to a firing test or after a firing test (and the defect is not due to the firing), the lot shall be rejected."

PAGE 15

Delete page 15 in its entirety and substitute new page 15 included as page 5 and new page 15a included as page 6.

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TABLE I. First article inspection

CLASSIFICATION OF CHARACTERISTICS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
	Jacket, Pointed	3 OF 6	9357839
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY 9342866

CLASSIFICATION	EXAMINATION OR TEST	CONFORMANCE CRITERIA	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	INSPECTION METHOD REFERENCE
	Wall thickness over cylindrical length of jacket (.024)	25, 0-1	3.2	SMTE
	Wall thickness at tapered portion of jacket (.016 min.)	25, 0-1	3.2	SMTE
	Evidence of poor workmanship	25, 0-1	3.2	Visual

NOTES:

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TABLE I. First article inspection

CLASSIFICATION OF CHARACTERISTICS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
	Jacket, Pointed With Filler, Point	4 OF 6	9357840
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: 9342866

CLASSIFICATION	EXAMINATION OR TEST	CONFORMANCE CRITERIA	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	INSPECTION METHOD REFERENCE
	Length, tracer cavity (.430)	25, 0-1	3.2	SMTE
	Evidence of poor workmanship	25, 0-1	3.2	Visual

NOTES:

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CLASSIFICATION OF CHARACTERISTICS

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.5.6.1	Cartridge, 5.56mm, Tracer, M856 (Inspection)	1 OF 3	9342865
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not Applicable

CLASSIFICATION	EXAMINATION OR TEST	CONFORMANCE CRITERIA	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	INSPECTION METHOD REFERENCE
Critical				
1.	Perforated case (6)	100%	3.1	Gage
2.	Case split in I, S or J location when	100%	3.1	Gage
3.	it is determined that there is a	100%	3.1	See note 2
4.	potential for loss of propellant.	100%	3.1	Gage
Special				
a.	Primer missing (32)	100%	3.1	Visual
b.	Primer cocked (33)	100%	3.1	Visual
c.	Primer inverted (34)	100%	3.1	Visual
Major				
101.	Total length	Level I	3.1	Gage
102.	Case split in I,S or J location when it is determined that there is no potential for loss of propellant.	Level I	3.1	Gage
103.	Corrosion or stain with etching (2)	Level I	3.1	Visual
104.	Chamfer missing on head (rim) (13)	Level I	3.1	Visual
105.	Case mouth not crimped in cannelure (11)	Level I	3.1	Visual
106.	No evidence of mouth anneal (21)	Level I	3.1	Visual
107.	Draw scratch (8)	Level I	3.1	Visual
108.	Split bullet jacket (24)	Level I	3.1	Visual

NOTES:

1. Each lightweight cartridge shall be disassembled and the propellant weighed. Any cartridge containing less than 13 grains of propellant shall be classed as a critical defect. Any cartridge containing 13 grains or more of propellant shall be classed as a major defect.

2. One hundred percent examination for weight may be either by weighing or by measuring for propellant fill; method used must be capable of detecting a cartridge containing less than 13 grains of propellant.

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QUALITY CONFORMANCE INSPECTION

CLASSIFICATION OF CHARACTERISTICS

MIL-C-63990C (AR)
AMENDMENT 3

PARAGRAPH	TITLE	SHEET	DRAWING NUMBER
4.5.6.1	Cartridge, 5.56mm. Tracer, M856 (Inspection)	1a OF 3	9342865
			NEXT HIGHER ASSEMBLY: Not applicable

CLASSIFICATION	EXAMINATION OR TEST	CONFORMANCE CRITERIA	REQUIREMENT PARAGRAPH	INSPECTION METHOD REFERENCE
109.	Loose bullet (25)	Level I	3.1	Visual
110.	Loose primer (35)	Level I	3.1	Visual

NOTES:

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PAGE 22

* TABLE IV Under "a, Perforation of firing pin indent in primer cup", delete the following:

"(1) M249 Machinegun 0 see 3/ 1"

and substitute:

"(1) M249 Machinegun 22 28 (see 3/) 40".

PAGE 24

* Note 3 Delete in its entirety and substitute the following:

"If defects in excess of the acceptance number in Table IV are noted in the first sample, a second sample consisting of double the quantity of cartridges specified under function and casualty in Table III shall be fired in both weapons. Prior to the testing of the second sample, the firing pip of the specific weapon in which the defect occurred shall be replaced with a new firing pin. If the cumulative number of defects from both the first and second sample exceeds the cumulative acceptance number in Table IV, the lot shall be rejected."

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